

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 2-3 · with clues

Name _____

Date _____

Use the clues. Change **one letter** each step to make the word that matches the clue.

Ladder 1

C H A T

Start here

1

You wear it outside when it is cold

2

It floats and carries people on water

3

A tall shoe for rain or snow

4

You put a sock on it

F O O D

Finish here

Ladder 2

N O N E

Start here

1

The number after eight

2

A tree with needles and cones

3

Mix red and white paint to get this

4

Where you wash your hands

S I L K

Finish here

Ladder 3

B A N K

Start here

1

A group that plays music together

2

Tiny grains you find on a beach

3

To make a letter go to someone

4

A new plant grows from this

F E E D

Finish here

Word Ladders

Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

	C	H	A	T	Start here
1	C	O	A	T	You wear it outside when it is cold
2	B	O	A	T	It floats and carries people on water
3	B	O	O	T	A tall shoe for rain or snow
4	F	O	O	T	You put a sock on it
	F	O	O	D	Finish here

Ladder 2

	N	O	N	E	Start here
1	N	I	N	E	The number after eight
2	P	I	N	E	A tree with needles and cones
3	P	I	N	K	Mix red and white paint to get this
4	S	I	N	K	Where you wash your hands
	S	I	L	K	Finish here

Ladder 3

	B	A	N	K	Start here
1	B	A	N	D	A group that plays music together
2	S	A	N	D	Tiny grains you find on a beach
3	S	E	N	D	To make a letter go to someone
4	S	E	E	D	A new plant grows from this
	F	E	E	D	Finish here